Viva and Oral Exam Practice

One copy-and-paste prompt that turns any AI chat into a viva examiner - it asks you one question at a time, listens to your spoken answer, asks follow-ups like a real examiner, and tells you how to sound clearer and more confident.

Notes by Shah Fahad

AI & Technology Innovator and Educator - Buner, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, Pakistan

Free student notes - Exam Prep set

What this note is: a single shortcut, on its own, so you can save it, print it and use it in seconds. Copy the prompt on page 2 into ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Muse or any other AI chat, add your topic, turn on voice mode if you have it, and your oral practice starts.

The copy-and-paste prompt

Viva and Oral Exam Practice Works in: ChatGPT - Claude - Gemini - Muse

> Act as my viva examiner for [TOPIC] at [CLASS / EXAM LEVEL]. Follow these rules strictly:
> 1. Ask me ONE question at a time and wait for my spoken answer before asking the next.
> 2. Start with an easy opening question, then slowly make the questions harder.
> 3. After each answer, ask ONE short follow-up question, like a real examiner - for example "Why?" or "Can you give an example?"
> 4. After my follow-up answer, tell me in 2-3 lines: what was correct, what was missing, and one better way to say it.
> 5. Also comment on my delivery: was my answer too long, too short, or unclear? Keep this advice kind and simple.
> 6. Do NOT give me the full answer before I try. If I am stuck, give a small hint first.
> 7. Ask 8 questions in total, then give me my score out of 10, my 2 weakest answers, and 3 points to practise again before the real viva.
> Start with question 1 now.

Fill the brackets: replace [TOPIC] with your subject and chapter, for example "the water cycle" or "fractions", and [CLASS / EXAM LEVEL] with your class, for example "Class 7" or "Matric".

How a viva practice session runs

1. **Paste the prompt** into any AI chat. If the app has a voice or microphone button, use it - a viva is spoken, so practise speaking.
2. **Answer out loud, in full sentences.** Do not type one-word answers. The examiner in the room will expect complete sentences too.
3. **Expect a follow-up.** Real examiners rarely stop at the first answer. A short "why" or "example, please" is normal - it is not a sign you were wrong.
4. **Read or listen to the feedback.** Note the better way to say each answer - that wording is what you will reuse in the real viva.
5. **Finish all 8 questions.** At the end you get a score, your weakest answers, and a short practice list.
6. **Practise the weak answers again.** Run the same prompt once more and ask it to focus only on the topics you missed.

> **Why speaking matters:** many students know the answer on paper but freeze when they must say it. Speaking your answers out loud, again and again, is what removes that fear - by exam day, the words feel familiar.

What it looks like in practice

Topic: the water cycle, Class 7. This is the spoken back-and-forth you will hear:

AI (examiner): Question 1 of 8: What is evaporation?

You: It is when water goes up.

AI (examiner): Follow-up: Water goes up from where, and because of what?

You: From seas and rivers, because of the heat of the sun.

AI (examiner): Correct - the sun heats water in seas, rivers and lakes, and it changes into vapour and rises. Your first answer was too short. A better way to say it: "Evaporation is the process in which water changes into vapour because of the sun's heat." Question 2 of 8: ...

Make it match your real viva

Add one of these short lines under the main prompt to change the practice:

Add this line	What changes
Be strict, like a real board examiner, and do not help me.	Full exam pressure - best in the last days before the viva.
Be gentle - this is my first viva and I feel nervous.	Easier questions and warmer feedback while you build confidence.
Ask the questions in Urdu, but I will answer in English.	Matches schools where the examiner mixes both languages.
Time each answer - tell me if I speak for more than one minute.	Teaches you to give complete but not endless answers.
At the end, give me 5 model answers I can learn for my weakest topics.	Gives you ready wording to practise after the session.

Use it honestly. Reading an AI-written answer aloud is not viva practice. Say your own answer first, in your own words - only then does the feedback help you.

Check the AI too. An AI examiner can occasionally correct you wrongly. If a correction surprises you, check that point in your textbook before changing what you learned - your book is the final authority for your exam.

More shortcuts in this series: Quiz Me Mode - Likely Exam Questions - Last-Day Revision Plan - Practice Test Maker - and many more free notes on the website.